

SENATE No. 964

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

John J. Cronin

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to study single-stair residential buildings.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>John J. Cronin</i>	<i>Worcester and Middlesex</i>	
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>2/19/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/19/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>3/4/2025</i>
<i>Brendan P. Crighton</i>	<i>Third Essex</i>	<i>3/27/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>

SENATE No. 964

By Mr. Cronin, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 964) of John J. Cronin, Patricia D. Jehlen, Mike Connolly and Manny Cruz for legislation to study single-stair residential buildings. Housing.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to study single-stair residential buildings.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 (a) Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, there shall be a special
2 commission to study and define conditions under which Single-Stair Multi-Family Residential
3 buildings up to six stories shall be legalized in Massachusetts. The commission shall produce a
4 building code amendment that allows single-stair multi-family residential buildings of up to six
5 stories, including measures for mitigating any adverse health and safety impacts unique to single-
6 stair multi-family residential buildings.

7 (b) The commission shall consist of 1 member representing the Fire Chiefs Association
8 of Massachusetts, 2 members of the American Institute of Architects, 1 member who is a
9 practicing fire engineer representing the National Fire Protection Association, 2 members
10 representing the Board of Building Regulations and Standards, 1 member representing the
11 American Planning Association Massachusetts Chapter, 1 member representing the Home
12 Builders and Remodelers Association, 1 member representing NAIOP, 1 member representing

the Center for Building in North America, 1 member representing a building official employed by a municipality with a Class 1 Fire Department, and 1 member representing Abundant Housing Massachusetts.

(c) The study shall build on the report Legalizing Mid-Rise Single-Stair Housing in Massachusetts produced by the Harvard Joint Center for Housing Studies, Boston Indicators, and Utile and shall include, but not be limited to: a technical study into the safety of single-stair residential buildings compared to two-staircase buildings, and a process map and timeline for implementation of the building code amendment.

(d) For costs associated with developing the study and its recommendations, \$250,000 shall be allocated from the General Fund.